

VALUE ADDITION NOTES

NATIONAL PARK - 3



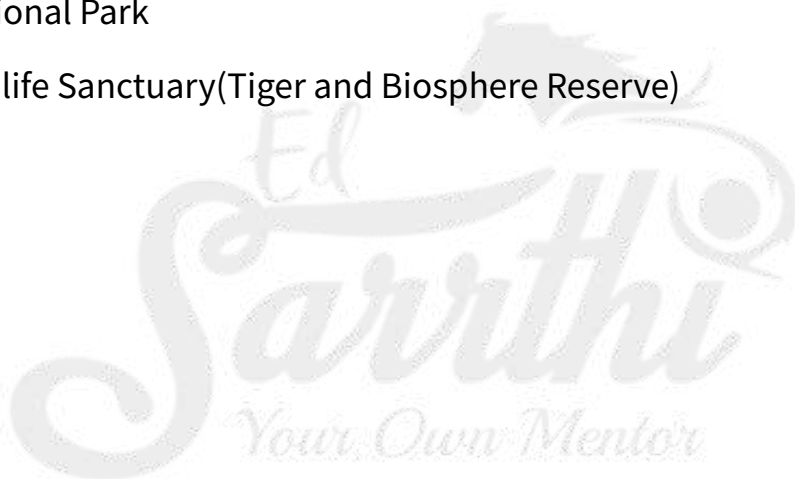
VALUE ADDITION NOTES

NATIONAL PARK

PART - 3

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1. Kanha National Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Madhya Pradesh, India
- **Important Facts** - An exciting conservation effort in this national park is the reintroduction of barasingha
- **Flora** - The lowland forest is a mixture of sal and other mixed-forest trees, interspersed with meadows. The highland forests are tropical moist, dry deciduous type and of a completely different nature from bamboo on slopes.
- **Fauna** - Kanha Tiger Reserve hosts populations of tiger, leopard, wild dog, sloth bear, foxes and jackals.



2. Sanjay National Park

- **Location** - Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh, India
- **Geography** - It is located in the Narmada Valley dry deciduous forests ecoregion.
- **Important Facts** - It is a part of the **Sanjay-Dubri Tiger Reserve**.
- **Flora** - The national park is mostly composed of **tropical forests of Sakhua trees** (sal trees).
- **Fauna** - The Bengal tiger, Indian leopard, Spotted deer, Sambar deer, wild boar, Nilgai, Chinkara, Civet, Porcupine, Monitor lizard, and 309 species of birds are found here. Among the many birds here are the Golden Hooded Oriole, Racket-tailed Drongo, Indian pitta, Rufous treepie, Lesser adjutant, Red-headed vulture, Cinereous vulture, White-rumped vulture, Egyptian vulture and Nightjar.



3. Satpura National Park(Tiger Reserve)

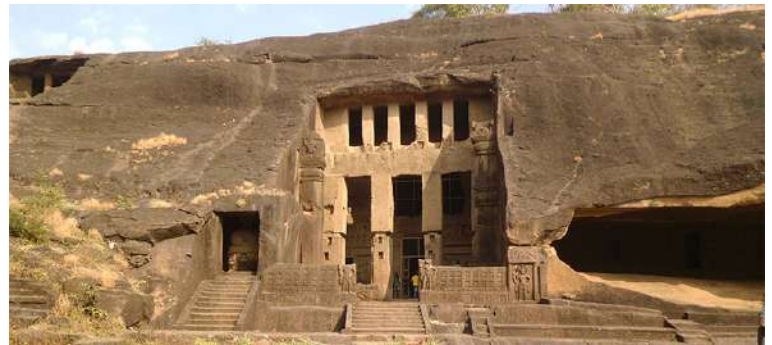
- **Location** - Madhya Pradesh, India
- **Geography** - The terrain of the national park is extremely rugged and consists of sandstone peaks, narrow gorges, ravines and dense forests.
- **Important Facts** - Its name is derived from the **Satpura Range**
- **Flora** - Saal is the most prominent flora of the National Park which is mainly found in the **Pachmarhi plateau** area of tiger reserve whereas lower plains on the northern side of the park mainly consist of teak forest on basaltic traps.
 - It has about 10% of the area which is classified as grasslands
- **Fauna** - leopard, sambar, chital, Indian muntjac, nilgai, four-horned antelope, Chinkara, wild boar, bear, black buck, fox, porcupine, flying squirrel, mouse deer, and Indian giant squirrel. Hornbills and peafowl are common birds found here.



4. Sanjay Gandhi National Park

- **Location** - Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
- **Important Facts** - It is notable as one of the major national parks **existing within a metropolis limit** and is one of the most visited parks in the world.
 - The **Kanheri Caves** in the centre of the park were an important Buddhist learning centre and pilgrimage site
- **Flora** - Kadamba, teak, karanj, shisham, and species of acacia, ziziphus, euphorbia, flame of the forest, red silk cotton and a number of other varieties of flowers.
 - The *karvi* shrub, as it is locally called in the Marathi language, only blooms once in eight years in a mass flowering covering the forest floor in a lavender blush. It grows in abundance in the Western Ghats hills near Mumbai and throughout the Sanjay Gandhi National Park as in other parts of its natural range.
- **Fauna** - Chital, rhesus macaque and bonnet macaque are some of the wild mammals often spotted inside the park. Other large mammals found in the park include black-naped or Indian hare, muntjac, porcupine, Asian palm civet, chevrotain, Hanuman or grey langur, Indian flying fox, sambar deer and leopard. One can also spot striped hyena or four-horned antelope.

- Some of the birds found in the park are jungle owlets, golden orioles, racket-tailed drongos, minivets, magpies, robins, hornbills, bulbuls, sunbirds, peacock, and woodpeckers.



5. Keibul Lamjao National Park

- **Location** - Manipur, India
- **Geography** - The park is a swamp with **floating mass of vegetation** created by accrual of organic garbage and biomass with soil particles that has been thickened into a solid form called **phumdis**, at the south-eastern side of the Loktak Lake, which has been declared a Ramsar site.
 - The distinctive nature of the park is that it is "too deep to be a marsh, too shallow to be a lake".

- **Important Facts** - The **only floating park in the world**, located in North East India, and an integral part of Loktak Lake.
 - The national park is characterized by floating decomposed plant material locally called phumdi
- **Flora** - The park, primarily composed of moist semi-evergreen forests, has a rich amalgam of aquatic, wetland and terrestrial ecosystem
- **Fauna** - Mammals reported are the hog deer , wild boar, large Indian civet, common otter , fox, jungle cat , Asian golden cat, bay bamboo rat, musk shrew, common shrew, flying fox and sambar
 - Kingfisher, black kite, lesser sky-lark, northern hill myna, Burmese pied myna, North Indian black drongos, lesser eastern jungle crow, yellow headed wagtail, spotbill duck, blue-winged teal, ruddy shelduck, threatened hooded crane, Burmese sarus sarus crane, Indian white-breasted waterhen and crimson-breasted pied woodpecker.



6. Nokrek National Park

- **Location** - Meghalaya, India
- **Geography** - The entire Biosphere Reserve is hilly. In most of the Biosphere Reserve area the soil is red loam
- **Important Facts** - UNESCO added this National park to its list of Biosphere Reserves in May 2009. Along with Balpakram national park, Nokrek is a hotspot of biodiversity in Meghalaya.
- **Flora** - There is a vast range of plants found in the park. A huge canopy of thick, tall and lush green forests cover Nokrek and its environment
- **Fauna** - red panda, Asian elephant, marbled cat, stump-tailed macaque, pig-tailed macaque, Hoolocks



7. Simlipal National Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Odisha, India
- **Geography** - With a wide range of rainfall and edaphic variations, from dry deciduous to moist green forests, it is suitable to many species of flora and fauna. Some of the beautiful waterfalls like Joranda and Barehipani Falls.
- **Important Facts** - It is part of the **Mayurbhanj Elephant Reserve**. Simlipal National Park derives its name from the abundance of red silk cotton trees growing in the area.
 - This protected area is part of the **UNESCO World Network of Biosphere Reserves**
- **Flora** - It lies in the Eastern Highlands moist deciduous forests ecoregion, with tropical moist broadleaf forest and tropical moist deciduous forests with dry deciduous hill forest and high level Sal forests. The grasslands and the savannas provide grazing grounds for the herbivores and hiding place to the carnivores.
- **Fauna** - The major mammals include tiger, leopard, Asian elephant, sambar, barking deer, gaur, jungle cat, wild boar, chausingha (four



horned antelope), giant squirrel and common langur. The grey hornbill, Indian pied hornbill, Malabar pied hornbill and Indian trogon are also found in the reserve.

- **Mugger crocodile**

8. Bhitarkanika National Park

- **Location** - Odisha, India
- **Geography** - It is surrounded by Bhitarkanika Wildlife Sanctuary. Gahirmatha Beach and Marine Sanctuary are to the east, separating swamp region and mangroves from the Bay of Bengal. The national park and wildlife sanctuary is inundated by the rivers Brahmani, Baitarani, Dhamra, Pathsala. It hosts many mangrove species, and is the **second largest mangrove ecosystem in India.**
- **Important Facts** - The area has been designated as the second **Ramsar site of the State after the Chilika Lake.**
- **Flora** - Mangroves are salt tolerant, complex and dynamic ecosystems that occur in tropical and subtropical intertidal regions. Bhitarkanika is one such location of a rich, lush green vibrant ecosystem lying in the estuarine region of Brahmani- Baitarani in the North-Eastern corner of Kendrapara district of Odisha.

- **Fauna** - The park is home to the saltwater crocodile, Indian python, black ibis, wild boar, rhesus monkey, chital, darter, cobra, monitor lizard. Olive ridley turtles nest on Gahirmatha and other nearby beaches.



9. Keoladio National Park

- **Location** - Rajasthan, India
- **Geography** - One third of the Keoladeo National Park is wetland with mounds, dykes and open water with or without submerged or emergent plants. The uplands have grasslands with tall grass species together with scattered trees and shrubs present in varying density.
 - Water remains only in some depressions. This alternate wetting and drying helps to maintain the ecology of the freshwater swamp, ideal for water-fowl and resident water birds.

- **Important Facts** - It is a famous **avifauna sanctuary** that hosts thousands of birds, especially during the winter season. It is also a World Heritage Site.
 - Keoladeo Ghana National Park is a **man-made and man-managed** wetland and one of the national parks of India.
- **Flora** - In an area characterized by sparse vegetation, the park is the only spot which has dense vegetation and trees. The principal vegetation types are tropical dry deciduous forests intermixed with dry grasslands. Where the forest has degraded, the greater part of the area is covered with shrubs and medium-sized trees. The park is a freshwater swamp and is flooded during the monsoon. The rest of the area remains dry
- **Fauna** - Macro invertebrates such as worms, insects, and mollusks, though more abundant in variety and numbers than any other group of organisms, are present mostly in aquatic habitats.



10. Sariska National Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Rajasthan, India
- **Geography** - It is a part of the Aravalli Range and the Khathiar-Gir dry **deciduous forests ecoregion**. It is rich in mineral resources, such as copper.
- **Important Facts** - It is the first reserve in the world with successfully relocated tigers.
- **Flora** - comprising scrub-thorn arid forests, dry deciduous forests, grasslands, and rocky hills. The dominant tree in the forests is dhok. Other trees include the salar , kadaya, dhak , gol , ber and khair. Bargad, arjun , gugal or bamboo. Shrubs are numerous, such as kair , adusta and jhar ber .
- **Fauna** - Bengal tiger, Indian leopard, jungle cat, caracal, striped hyena, golden jackal, chital, sambar deer, nilgai, wild boar, small Indian civet, Javan mongoose, ruddy mongoose, honey badger, Rhesus macaque and Northern plains gray langur and Indian hare
 - Rarest feathered species like **grey partridge, white-throated** kingfisher, Indian peafowl, bush quail, sandgrouse, tree pie, golden-backed woodpecker, crested serpent eagle and the Indian eagle-owl.



11. Ranthambore National Park

- **Location** - Rajasthan, India
- **Geography** - It is bounded to the north by the **Banas River** and to the south by the **Chambal River**. It is named after the historic Ranthambore Fort, which lies within the park.
- **Important Facts** - **Padam Talao** is the largest of the many lakes in the park. A red sandstone Jogi Mahal is at the edge of the lake. A gigantic Banyan tree, considered to be India's second largest, is also near the lake.
- **Flora** - Ranthambore National Park harbours **dry deciduous forests** and open grassy meadow.

- **Fauna** - Bengal tiger, Indian leopard, nilgai, wild boar, sambar, striped hyena, sloth bear, southern plains gray langur, rhesus macaque, mugger crocodile and chital.



12. Desert National Park

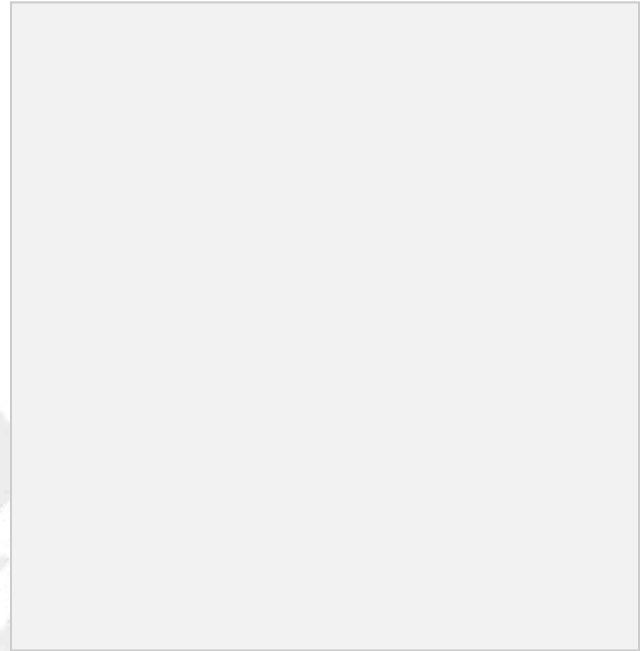
- **Location** - Rajasthan, India
- **Geography** - The Desert National Park is an excellent example of the ecosystem of the Thar Desert. Sand dunes form around 20% of the Park. The major landform consists of craggy rocks and compact salt lake bottoms, intermedial areas and fixed dunes.
- **Important Facts** - Great Indian Bustard

- **Flora** - The vegetation is sparse, and patches of sewan grass and aak shrub can be seen. The landscape includes craggy rocks and compact salt lake bottoms, as well as intermediate areas and both fixed and shifting dunes. Around 20 percent of the vast expanse is covered with sand dunes.
- **Fauna** - Many eagles, harriers, falcons, buzzards, kestrel and vultures are spotted here. Short-toed eagles, tawny eagles, spotted eagles, laggar falcons and kestrels are the most common among these. Sand grouses are spotted near small ponds or lakes. The endangered great Indian bustard is a magnificent bird found in relatively fair numbers.



13. Kanchendzonga National Park

- **Location** - Sikkim, India
- **Important Facts** - It was inscribed to the UNESCO World Heritage Sites list in July 2016, becoming the first "**Mixed Heritage**" site of India. It was included in the UNESCO Man and the Biosphere Programme.
 - The park contains Tholung Monastery, a gompa located in the park's buffer zone. It is considered one of the most sacred monasteries in Sikkim.
- **Flora** - The vegetation of the park include temperate broadleaf and mixed forests consisting of oaks, fir, birch, maple, willow. The vegetation of the park also includes Alpine grasses and shrubs at higher altitudes along with many medicinal plants and herbs.
- **Fauna** - The park contains many mammal species including musk deer, snow leopard, Himalayan tahr, dhole, sloth bear, viverrids, Himalayan black bear, red panda, Tibetan wild ass, Himalayan blue sheep, serow, goral and takin, as well as reptiles including rat snake and Russell's viper.
 - species of birds are found inside the park including blood pheasant, satyr tragopan, osprey, Himalayan griffon, lammergeier, Western tragopan, green pigeon, Tibetan snowcock, snow pigeon, impeyan pheasant, Asian emerald cuckoo, sunbird and eagle



14. Mudumalai national Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Tamil Nadu, India
- **Geography** - It shares its boundaries with the states of Karnataka and Kerala.
- **Flora** - The dominant type of habitat found in the Mudumalai National Park is **Tropical moist forest**. Tropical dry forest and scrub forests are also found here. Moist bamboo brakes are found amidst dry deciduous, moist deciduous and semi-evergreen forests and along the fringes of riparian forests and swamps.

- **Fauna** - home to several endangered and vulnerable species including Indian elephant, Bengal tiger, gaur and Indian leopard. There are at least 266 species of birds in the sanctuary, including critically endangered Indian white-rumped vulture and long-billed vulture



15. Mukurthi National Park

- **Location** - Tamil Nadu, India
- **Geography** - The park is characterised by montane grasslands and shrublands interspersed with sholas in a high altitude area of high rainfall, near-freezing temperatures and high winds.

- **Important Facts** - The park was created to protect its keystone species, the **Nilgiri tahr**.
- **Fauna** - Several threatened mammal species live here including Nilgiri tahr, Indian elephant, Bengal tiger, Nilgiri marten, Nilgiri langur and Bonhote's mouse.



16. Indira Gandhi National Park(Anamalai Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Tamil Nadu, India
- **Important Facts** - It has significant anthropological diversity with more than 4600 Adivasi people from six tribes of indigenous people living in 34 settlements. The tribes

are the Kadars, Malasars, Malaimalasar s, Pulaiyars, Muduvars and the Eravallan (Eravalar)

- **Flora** - wet evergreen forest and semi-evergreen forest, montane shola-grassland, moist deciduous, dry deciduous, thorn forests and marshes. Tropical montane forests occur at higher elevations and are interspersed with montane grasslands, forming the shola-grassland complex.
- **Fauna** - Threatened species of mammals in the sanctuary include: the endangered Bengal tiger, Indian elephant, Indian leopard, **Nilgiri tahr and lion-tailed macaque**,
 - the vulnerable brown mongoose, gaur, Malabar spiny dormouse, Nilgiri langur, rusty-spotted cat, sambar deer, sloth bear and smooth-coated otter,
 - the near threatened Indian giant squirrel, Indian leopard and Indian pangolin.



17. Gulf of Mannar Marine National Park

- **Location** - Tamil Nadu, India
- **Important Facts** - **Mangroves** dominate the intertidal zones of the park islands
- **Flora** - The park includes estuaries, mudflats, beaches and forests of the near shore environment. It also includes marine components such as coral reefs, seaweed communities, sea grasses, salt marshes and mangroves.
- **Fauna** - The dugong, Indo-Pacific bottlenose dolphin, finless porpoise, spinner dolphin, common dolphin, Risso's dolphin, melon-headed whale, and dwarf sperm whale. Larger whales include sperm whale, minke whale, Bryde's whale, sei whale, and critically endangered species including humpback whale, fin whale, and blue whale.



18. Clouded Leopard National Park

- **Location** - Tripura, India
- **Important Facts** - It is home to **four species of primate monkey including Phayre's langur**



19. Rajaji National Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - Uttarakhand, India
- **Important Facts** - Rajaji National Park has been named after C. Rajagopalachari (*Rajaji*), a prominent leader of the Freedom Struggle, the second and last Governor-General of independent India and one of the first recipients of India's highest civilian award Bharat Ratna (in 1954).

- **Flora** - Rajaji National Park of India is nestled between the **Shivalik ranges and the Indo-Gangetic plains**. Broadleaved deciduous forests, riverine vegetation, scrubland, grasslands and pine forests form the range of flora in this park.
- **Fauna** - Asian elephant, Bengal tiger, Indian Leopard, Striped hyena, Jungle cat, Goral Indian hare, Sloth bear, Himalayan black bear, King cobra, Jackal, Barking deer, Sambar, Wild boar, Rhesus macaque, Indian langur, Indian porcupine, Monitor lizard, Python



20. Jim Corbett National Park

- **Location** - Uttarakhand, India
- **Geography** - Corbett National Park comprises area of hills, riverine belts, marshy depressions, grasslands and a large lake. The elevation ranges from 1,300 to 4,000 ft (400 to 1,220 m). Winter nights are cold but the days are bright and sunny. It rains from

July to September. The park has sub-Himalayan belt geographical and ecological characteristics

- **The Ramganga river Passes** through it.
- **Important Facts** - The park was the **first to come under the Project Tiger initiative**. It was named after hunter and naturalist Jim Corbett.
- **Flora** - It has numerous ravines, ridges, minor streams and small plateaus with varying aspects and degrees of slope.
- **Fauna** - Bengal tigers, Leopards, jungle cat, fishing cat and leopard cat, barking deer, sambar deer, hog deer and chital, sloth and Himalayan black bears, Indian grey mongoose, otters, yellow-throated martens, Himalayan goral, Indian pangolins, and langur and rhesus macaques, Owls and nightjars



21. Nanda Devi National Park(Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve)

- **Location** - Uttarakhand, India
- **Geography** - Within the National Park lies the **Nanda Devi Sanctuary**, a glacial basin surrounded by a ring of peaks between 6,000 metres (19,700 ft) and 7,500 m (24,600 ft) high, and drained by the Rishi Ganga through the Rishi Ganga Gorge.
- **Important Facts** - The National Park was inscribed a **World Heritage Site by UNESCO**
- **Flora** - Vegetation is scarce In the inner sanctuary due to the dryness of the conditions. One will not find vegetation near Nanda Devi Glacier.
- **Fauna** - Himalayan musk deer, mainland serow, Himalayan tahr, Goral, snow leopard, Himalayan black bear and perhaps also brown bear



22. Valley of Flowers National Park

- **Location** - Uttarakhand, India
- **Geography** - The Valley of Flowers is a high-altitude Himalayan valley. region containing a diversity of alpine flora, representative of the Western Himalayan alpine shrub and meadows ecoregion.
- **Flora** - The valley has three sub-alpine between 3,200 m and 3,500 m which is the limit for trees, lower alpine between 3,500 m and 3,700 m, and higher alpine above 3,700 m. The habitats include valley bottom, river bed, small forests, meadows, eroded, scrubby and stable slopes, moraine, plateau, bogs, stone desert and caves.
- **Fauna** - Asiatic black bear, snow leopard, musk deer, brown bear, red fox and blue sheep.



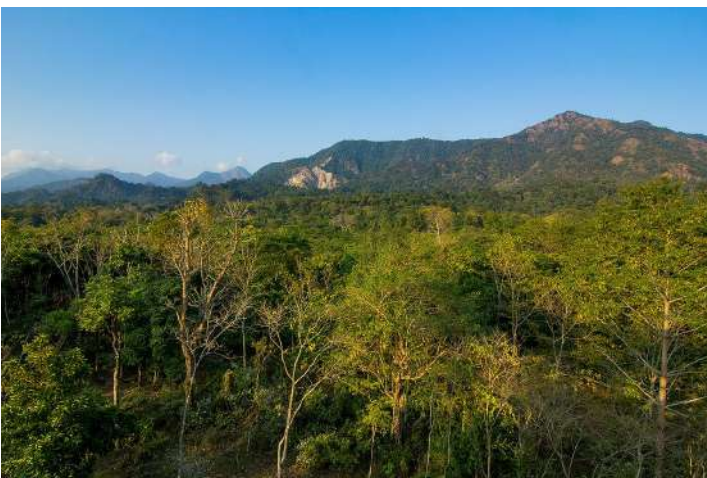
23. Dudhwa National Park

- **Location** - Uttar Pradesh, India
- **Geography** - It represents one of the few remaining areas of the diverse and productive Terai ecosystem.
- **Important Facts** - Indian rhinoceros was reintroduced into Dudhwa from Pobitora Sanctuary in Assam and Nepal.
- **Flora** - The area of the park falls within the Upper Gangetic plains and is a vast alluvial plain. The forests, especially the sal forests, have always been very dense and can be categorized into northern tropical semi-evergreen forest, northern Indian moist deciduous forest, tropical seasonal swamp forest and northern tropical dry deciduous forest.
- **Fauna** - Tigers, Leopard, swamp deer, sambar deer, barking deer, spotted deer, hog deer, sloth bear, ratel, jackal, civets, jungle cat, fishing cat, leopard cat.



24. Buxa National Park(Tiger Reserve)

- **Location** - West Bengal, India
- **Important Facts** - **Rajabhatkhawa Vulture Breeding Centre** at Buxa Tiger Reserve for the breeding and conservation of endangered Indian vultures
- **Flora** - Forest types include, Northern dry deciduous, Eastern Bhabar and Terai sal, East Himalayan moist mixed deciduous forest, Sub-Himalayan secondary wet mixed forest, Eastern sub-montane semi-evergreen forest, Northern tropical evergreen forest, East Himalayan subtropical wet hill forest, Moist sal savannah, Low alluvium, Savannah woodland
- **Fauna** - Mammals present include Asian elephant, gaur, Sambar deer, clouded leopard, Indian leopard.



25. Neora Valley National Park

- **Location** - Darjeeling, West Bengal, India
- **Geography** - pristine undisturbed natural habitat with rugged inaccessible hilly terrain
- **Flora** - Neora Valley sustains a unique ecosystem where tropical, subtropical, sub-temperate, and temperate vegetative systems still harbour a wealth of flora and fauna. The forest consists of mixed species like rhododendron, bamboo, oak, ferns, sal, etc. The valley also has numerous species of orchids.
- **Fauna** - Mammals reported from this area are Indian leopard, five viverrid species, Asiatic black bear, sloth bear, Asian golden cat, wild boar, leopard cat, goral, serow, barking deer, sambar deer, flying squirrel and tahr, red panda, clouded leopard.



26. Sunderbans Wildlife Sanctuary(Tiger and Biosphere Reserve)

- **Location** - West Bengal, India
- **Geography** - It is part of the Sundarbans on the Ganges Delta, and adjacent to the Sundarban Reserve Forest in Bangladesh. The delta is densely covered by mangrove forests, and is **one of the largest reserves for the Bengal tiger.**
- **Important Facts** - It is a **UNESCO World Heritage Site inscribed in 1987**, and it has been designated as a **Ramsar site since 2019**. It is considered as a **World Network of Biosphere Reserve (Man and Biosphere Reserve) from 1989.**
- **Flora** - Vast area of mangrove forests with a variety of flora and diverse fauna in a unique ecosystem. Sundarban has achieved its name from the **Sundari tree.**
- **Fauna** - Royal Bengal tigers, fishing cats, leopard cats, macaques, wild boar, Indian grey mongoose, fox, jungle cat, flying fox, chital.
 - Some of the birds commonly found in this region are openbill storks, black-capped kingfishers, black-headed ibis, water hens, coots, pheasant-tailed jacanas, pariah kites, brahminy kite, marsh harriers, swamp partridges, red junglefowl, spotted doves.

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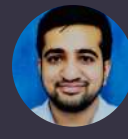
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